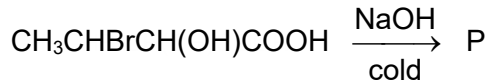


- 23** 3-Bromo-2-hydroxybutanoic acid is reacted with an excess of cold aqueous NaOH to give compound P.



What could P be?

- A** $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{COOH}$
- B** $\text{CH}_3\text{CHBrCH}(\text{OH})\text{COO}^-\text{Na}^+$
- C** $\text{CH}_3\text{CHBrCH}(\text{O}^-\text{Na}^+)\text{COO}^-\text{Na}^+$
- D** $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}(\text{O}^-\text{Na}^+)\text{CH}(\text{O}^-\text{Na}^+)\text{COO}^-\text{Na}^+$